Patient Rights and Responsibilities

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When you are well informed, take part in decisions about your treatment, and talk openly with your doctor and our staff, you help make your care more effective.

You Have the Right To:

- Be treated with dignity, consideration and respect, and receive safe care at all times, free from all forms of abuse or harassment.
- Be protected from discrimination or reprisal when you use your rights. Discrimination is against the law: in keeping with anti-discrimination laws and regulations, patients may not be discriminated against based on race, color, national origin, disability or age.
- Have our health care professionals and staff make reasonable efforts to communicate in the language you primarily use.
- Take part in discussions and be fully informed about your diagnosis, treatment or procedures and the expected outcomes. You have the right to take an active part in decisions about your medical care, and to consent to or refuse treatment to the extent permitted by law.
- Receive as much information as you need about your treatment choices, in clear language you can understand. You may involve anyone you choose, including a health care proxy, family members or friends, to help you make decisions.
- Personal privacy and confidentiality. Our office fully complies with HIPAA, and all of your health information and personal records will be kept confidential.
- Respectful and effective pain management.
- Know the names, credentials and roles of the people caring for you, and be informed of the services available at our facility.
- Receive information about advance directives. Advance directives are not accepted by the facility; see the Advance Directives form.
- Reasonable continuity of care, and to know in advance the time and location of your appointment and the doctor you will see.
- Review your medical record and ask questions about it, unless restricted by law.
- Know of any relationships with other parties that may influence your care.
- Leave the facility, even against medical advice.
- Know the rules and regulations that apply to your conduct as a patient, and how to get after-hours and emergency care.
- Examine and receive an explanation of your bill, regardless of how it is paid; know the specific fees for services; and know our payment policies (cash, check, credit card and payment plans).
- Know that this is a physician-owned facility.
- Choose your own physician, including a physician outside our practice.
- Voice concerns, complaints or problems about the care you received, out loud or in writing, by contacting our office manager or administrator. Grievance forms are available from any staff member, and we will respond in writing.

If We Can't Resolve Your Concern

- NC Medical Board: www.ncmedboard.org or 1-800-253-9653
- Office of the Medicare Beneficiary Ombudsman: www.medicare.gov or 1-800-633-4227

- Carolina Center for Medical Excellence: 1-800-682-2650
- NC Division of Health Service Regulation: 1-800-624-3004 or 919-855-4500
- NC Ombudsman: 1-877-201-3750

As a Patient, You Agree To:

- Give complete and accurate information about your symptoms, past medical history, allergies, medicines (including over-the-counter products and dietary supplements), use of chemical substances, and current health.
- Give complete and accurate contact information, including your address, phone number and date of birth, and all of your insurance information.
- Tell us whether you clearly understand your medical care and what is expected of you in your plan of care.
- Follow your treatment plan and care instructions.
- Keep your appointments, and let us know if you can't.
- Accept responsibility for your actions if you refuse planned treatment or don't follow your doctor's orders.
- Accept financial responsibility, and make sure the costs of your care are paid as promptly as possible.
- Follow facility policies and procedures, and tell us about any advance directives.
- Provide a responsible adult to drive you home and stay with you for 24 hours, if your physician requires it.
- Be considerate of the rights of other patients and staff.
- Respect your own personal property and that of others in the facility.
- Tell the staff about any discomfort or pain, and any patient safety concerns.
- Share your values, beliefs and traditions so the staff can provide appropriate care.

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